

# What Dropped This Week

## The May 12, 2026 ADAP-to-AISH Release An Information Analysis

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Subject: Alberta Disability Assistance Program (ADAP) — final regulations and May 12, 2026 government release

Effective: July 1, 2026

Affected population: approximately 80,000 Albertans currently on AISH

Source basis: alberta.ca, May 12, 2026 release and ADAP Fact Sheet; alberta.ca/alberta-disability-assistance-program; Red Deer Advocate; Lethbridge Herald; St. Albert Gazette; Inclusion Alberta; published analytical work by Gillian Petit (economist); OAPD 2025–2027 Strategic Plan.

This document records what was publicly released by the Government of Alberta in the week of May 11–16, 2026 regarding the AISH-to-ADAP transition, identifies what is new in the released regulations relative to the August 2025 Discussion Guide, and catalogs the analytical and community responses now on the public record. This is documentation. It is not advocacy framing on top of documentation.

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### **The Alberta Disability System Breakdown — Advocate**

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## Executive Summary

On May 12, 2026, the Government of Alberta released final regulations for the Alberta Disability Assistance Program (ADAP), accompanied by a media release titled *Expanding support for Albertans with disabilities* and a supporting ADAP Fact Sheet. These materials confirm specific numbers, eligibility criteria, transition structures, and appeal pathways that were proposed in the August 2025 Discussion Guide. This document records what was confirmed, what is new, and what is now on the public record from external analytical and community voices.

### Five findings drive this document:

- **Approximately 50,000 Albertans currently on AISH will transition to ADAP.** Approximately 30,000 will automatically remain on AISH based on four locked-in criteria. This is the first time the government has published this split publicly.
- **The ADAP core monthly benefit is locked at \$1,740 — \$200 less than the AISH rate of \$1,940.** A \$200 monthly transition benefit holds the dollar amount steady for current AISH recipients moving to ADAP, but only until December 31, 2027. After that, all ADAP recipients receive \$1,740.
- **A new cohabitation cut takes effect August 2026.** In households where two adults both receive disability income assistance (AISH or ADAP), each partner receives 88 per cent of the individual maximum — a reduction of roughly \$232 per partner, per month at AISH rates. This cut was not in the August 2025 Discussion Guide.
- **Recalibrated child benefits descend per dependent:** \$300 for the first child, \$117 for the second, \$88 for the third, \$59 for the fourth, \$30 for each additional. This structure was also not in the August 2025 Discussion Guide.
- **The October 2025 OAPD Strategic Plan, published by the Office of the Advocate for Persons with Disabilities, commits the Advocate to championing UNCRPD Article 28 (Adequate Standard of Living) and reviewing income support programs to identify gaps.** The Advocate publicly endorsed ADAP in February 2025. The strategic plan was published eight months after that endorsement. The May 12, 2026 regulations reduce the base monthly benefit for approximately 50,000 Albertans by \$200.

**What this document is.** A documentary information analysis of what was released the week of May 11–16, 2026, and the public record around it. It does not allege motive. It records what the government said, what is new in what they said, what their own publicly funded officers committed to before saying it, and what external analysts and community voices have placed on the public record in response.

## 1. Timeline: How We Got to May 12, 2026

The May 12, 2026 release is the third major public communication from the Government of Alberta on the AISH-to-ADAP transition. Each communication added specificity. Understanding what was new on May 12 requires understanding what came before.

### February 4, 2025 — Announcement

Minister Jason Nixon announces the Alberta Disability Assistance Program (ADAP) with a launch date of July 2026. The announcement is accompanied by endorsements from Greg McMeekin (Advocate for Persons with Disabilities), Jacob McGregor (chair, Premier's Council for the Status of Persons with Disabilities), Kevin McNichol (CEO, Prospect Human Services), and Katherine Such (CEO, Easter Seals Alberta Society). The framing is that “people with disabilities should not be punished for getting a job” and that ADAP will provide pathways to employment for individuals who can work but still need supports.

Source: [alberta.ca news release “Empowering Albertans with disabilities,” February 4, 2025](#).

### August 13, 2025 — Discussion Guide Released

ALSS publishes *Transforming Disability Income Assistance in Alberta: Discussion Guide*. The guide proposes a \$1,740 ADAP rate against the current \$1,940 AISH rate, a \$200 transition benefit until December 31, 2027, and a structural division between AISH (for those “permanently unable to work”) and ADAP (for those “assessed as having some ability to work”). The guide proposes employment exemption changes — lowering the AISH exemption from \$1,072 to \$350 single, and reducing spousal/partner exemptions. A public engagement survey is launched with a September 12, 2025 deadline. Government telephone town halls are held September 4 and 5, 2025.

Source: [alss-transforming-disability-income-assistance-discussion-guide.pdf](#), Government of Alberta, August 2025.

### August 18, 2025 — First Formal Opposition

Inclusion Alberta releases a media statement titled *Alberta Disability Assistance Program (ADAP) Could Leave Thousands with Disabilities in Deeper Poverty*. The statement quotes CEO Trish Bowman: ADAP will “drive Albertans with disabilities deeper into poverty and despair.” Inclusion Alberta’s analysis, citing economist Gillian Petit, identifies a financial break-even point of approximately \$25,368 annual employment income — below which ADAP recipients receive less total income than AISH recipients with the same earnings.

Source: [inclusionalberta.org/connections](#), August 18, 2025.

### October 2025 — OAPD Strategic Plan Published

The Office of the Advocate for Persons with Disabilities publishes its *2025–2027 Strategic Plan*. Priority 2 commits the office to “Champion an Adequate Standard of Living,” anchored explicitly in Article 28 of the United Nations Convention on the Rights of Persons with Disabilities (UNCRPD), and to “Review federal and provincial income support programs to identify gaps and recommend improvements.” The Advocate is Greg McMeekin, who endorsed ADAP in February 2025. The strategic plan’s ISBN is 978-1-4601-6394-8.

Source: [alss-oapd-advocate-for-persons-with-disabilities-2025-2027-strategic-plan.pdf](#), Government of Alberta, October 2025.

### May 11, 2026 — Municipal Vote Notice

Tristan Oram of the *St. Albert Gazette* reports that Coun. Amanda Patrick of St. Albert has submitted a notice of motion calling on the province to pause ADAP implementation and undertake consultation with disability advocacy organizations and municipalities. The article confirms Edmonton, Red Deer, Camrose, and Calgary as either having passed or being in discussion to pass similar motions. The St. Albert vote is scheduled for May 19, 2026.

Source: [stalbertgazette.com/local-news](https://stalbertgazette.com/local-news), May 11, 2026.

## **May 12, 2026 — Final Regulations Released**

Minister Nixon releases *Expanding support for Albertans with disabilities*. The accompanying ADAP Fact Sheet and updated [alberta.ca/alberta-disability-assistance-program](https://alberta.ca/alberta-disability-assistance-program) page lock in specific numbers and structures, including the 50,000/30,000 transition split, the \$1,740 base benefit, the 88 per cent cohabitation reduction effective August 2026, the recalibrated child benefit schedule, the expanded employment income exemptions, and the appeal architecture including the new ADAP Medical Appeal Panel. Mid-May letter distribution to AISH recipients begins.

Source: [alberta.ca](https://alberta.ca) news release “Expanding support for Albertans with disabilities,” May 12, 2026; [alss-adap-fact-sheet.pdf](#); [alberta.ca/alberta-disability-assistance-program](https://alberta.ca/alberta-disability-assistance-program) (accessed May 16, 2026).

## **May 13–16, 2026 — Media and Community Response**

The *Red Deer Advocate* publishes coverage May 13 confirming the 50,000/30,000 split and quoting a Red Deer AISH recipient who has not yet received the promised mid-May letter. Inclusion Lethbridge publishes an open letter in the *Lethbridge Herald* on May 16, calling fundamental aspects of ADAP “deeply concerning” and noting that both the AISH and ADAP rates fall below the Lethbridge Market Basket Measure for a single person (approximately \$2,205/month). Jon Auger publishes a Substack piece May 16 linking ADAP to Premier Smith’s April 2026 remarks on conditional inclusion, followed by additional pieces May 18 and May 19.

Sources: [reddeeradvocate.com](https://reddeeradvocate.com) (May 13, 2026); [lethbridgeherald.com](https://lethbridgeherald.com) (May 16, 2026); [jonauger.substack.com](https://jonauger.substack.com) (May 16, 18, 19, 2026).

## 2. The Locked-In Numbers

The May 12, 2026 release confirms specific figures that were either absent from or proposed only in draft form in the August 2025 Discussion Guide. The numbers below are stated by the Government of Alberta in the published May 12 materials. They are reproduced here for documentation purposes.

### Base monthly benefit and transition

| Item                                              | Current AISH                       | ADAP (starting July 1, 2026)                           |
|---------------------------------------------------|------------------------------------|--------------------------------------------------------|
| Core monthly living allowance                     | \$1,940                            | \$1,740                                                |
| Transition benefit for AISH-to-ADAP recipients    | Not applicable                     | \$200/month, until December 31, 2027                   |
| Effective monthly benefit during transition       | \$1,940                            | $\$1,740 + \$200 = \$1,940$ (until Dec 31, 2027)       |
| Effective monthly benefit January 1, 2028 forward | \$1,940 (those who remain on AISH) | \$1,740 (transition benefit ends; all ADAP recipients) |

Source: ADAP Fact Sheet, [alberta.ca](https://alberta.ca), May 12, 2026.

Note: both rates above include the federal Canada Disability Benefit (up to \$200/month). Alberta deducts the CDB from the provincial payment; the federal benefit does not add to recipient income.

### Employment income exemptions

An exemption is the amount a recipient can earn from employment in a month before their disability benefit is reduced. AISH single recipients can currently earn \$1,072/month before reductions begin (per the August 2025 Discussion Guide); effective July 1, 2026, that exemption is restructured.

| Recipient category                           | Exempt earnings (effective July 1, 2026) |
|----------------------------------------------|------------------------------------------|
| AISH Single or Parent                        | \$350/month                              |
| ADAP Single                                  | \$700/month                              |
| ADAP Parent (one or more dependent children) | \$1,100/month                            |
| AISH or ADAP Cohabiting Partner              | \$1,500/month                            |

Source: [alberta.ca](https://alberta.ca) ADAP page, accessed May 16, 2026; ADAP Fact Sheet, May 12, 2026.

The government states that ADAP recipients can earn up to \$45,240 annually in employment income while still receiving partial financial benefits, and that employment income above \$700 per month will be “gradually deducted starting with less than a cent per dollar and increasing significantly approaching \$45,000 employment income per year.” The government has not published the full clawback schedule. Economist Gillian Petit, cited by Inclusion Alberta in their August 2025 analysis, modeled a clawback structure based on the Discussion Guide’s case studies. Section 10 of this document reproduces that modeled structure.

### Spousal pension exemption

Starting July 2026, the first \$1,200 per month of spousal or cohabiting partner pension income is fully exempt from benefit calculations. Twenty-five per cent of any remaining amount is also exempt. This represents an increase over previous spousal pension exemption thresholds.

### Two-recipient cohabitation reduction (88 per cent)

Effective the August 2026 benefit period, in households where two adults both receive disability income assistance (AISH or ADAP), each partner will receive 88 per cent of the maximum individual benefit. Eighty-eight per cent of \$1,940 (AISH) is \$1,707.20 — a reduction of \$232.80 per partner, per month. Eighty-eight per cent of \$1,740 (ADAP) is \$1,531.20 — a reduction of \$208.80 per partner, per month. This structural cut was not in the August 2025 Discussion Guide.

Source: ADAP Fact Sheet, [alberta.ca](http://alberta.ca), May 12, 2026; cross-check — [alberta.ca](http://alberta.ca) ADAP page, accessed May 16, 2026.

### Recalibrated child benefits

Child benefit rates under AISH and ADAP have been “recalibrated to reflect other child-related supports including the federal Canada Child Benefit.” The recalibrated rates are:

| Child                 | Monthly Child Benefit |
|-----------------------|-----------------------|
| First child           | \$300                 |
| Second child          | \$117                 |
| Third child           | \$88                  |
| Fourth child          | \$59                  |
| Each additional child | \$30                  |

Per the May 12 release, these recalibrated rates will be applied starting the August 2026 benefit period and the government states they will increase child benefits for approximately 7,000 families. The descending structure and the explicit reference to offset against the Canada Child Benefit was not in the August 2025 Discussion Guide.

Source: ADAP Fact Sheet, [alberta.ca](http://alberta.ca), May 12, 2026.

### 3. What is New on May 12 Relative to August 2025

The August 2025 Discussion Guide established the broad architecture of ADAP. The May 12, 2026 release confirms, modifies, and adds to that architecture. The table below identifies each material change.

| Element                                          | August 2025 Discussion Guide                  | May 12, 2026 Regulations                                  |
|--------------------------------------------------|-----------------------------------------------|-----------------------------------------------------------|
| ADAP base benefit                                | Proposed at \$1,740/month                     | Confirmed at \$1,740/month                                |
| AISH-to-ADAP transition benefit                  | Proposed \$200/month until December 31, 2027  | Confirmed \$200/month until December 31, 2027             |
| Single ADAP employment exemption                 | Not specified beyond “significant exemptions” | \$700/month confirmed                                     |
| Parent ADAP employment exemption                 | Not specified                                 | \$1,100/month confirmed                                   |
| Cohabiting partner employment exemption          | Reduced to \$1,500/month (from \$2,612)       | \$1,500/month confirmed                                   |
| Annual employment income cap                     | Not specified                                 | \$45,240/year confirmed as ceiling for benefits           |
| AISH employment exemption                        | Reduced from \$1,072 to \$350 single          | \$350/month confirmed for AISH single or parent           |
| Two-recipient household reduction                | <b>Not present</b>                            | <b>88% individual benefit each (new structural cut)</b>   |
| Spousal pension exemption                        | Discussed; specifics not finalized            | First \$1,200/month fully exempt; 25% of remainder exempt |
| Child benefit rates                              | Not detailed in plain language                | \$300/\$117/\$88/\$59/\$30 descending schedule            |
| Auto-stay-on-AISH categories                     | Discussed in general terms                    | Four specific criteria locked in (see Section 5)          |
| Population split                                 | Not published                                 | ~50,000 to ADAP, ~30,000 auto-stay on AISH                |
| Body that hears ADAP eligibility appeals         | Referred to as “ADAP Medical Review Panel”    | Renamed: “ADAP Medical Appeal Panel”                      |
| AISH Medical Review Panel decision appealability | Stated as not appealable                      | Confirmed not appealable                                  |
| Employment supports investment                   | Not stated as a specific budget figure        | “Nearly \$250 million” in Budget 2026                     |

|                            |                       |                                                              |
|----------------------------|-----------------------|--------------------------------------------------------------|
| Letter notification timing | Stated as forthcoming | Mid-May 2026 distribution confirmed; reports indicate delays |
|----------------------------|-----------------------|--------------------------------------------------------------|

Three additions are particularly noteworthy because they did not exist as consultation items in the August 2025 Discussion Guide. The cohabitation 88 per cent reduction, the descending child benefit schedule explicitly framed against the federal Canada Child Benefit, and the renaming of the appellate body were introduced through regulation rather than through the publicly engaged consultation process. The government’s position is that engagement concluded in March 2026 and regulations were developed from engagement results.

Source: [alberta.ca](#) ADAP page, accessed May 16, 2026; cross-reference — [alss-transforming-disability-income-assistance-discussion-guide.pdf](#) (August 2025).



## 4. The 50,000 / 30,000 Split

From the ADAP Fact Sheet released May 12, 2026:

*“About 50,000 Albertans will transition to the new ADAP, and 30,000 current AISH clients will automatically remain on AISH.”*

Source: ADAP Fact Sheet (alss-adap-fact-sheet.pdf), Government of Alberta, May 12, 2026, p. 2.

This is the first time the Government of Alberta has published this split. Three observations are documented here without inference.

### **Observation 1: The transitioning group is the larger group**

Approximately 62.5 per cent of current AISH recipients are slated to transition to ADAP. Approximately 37.5 per cent will automatically remain on AISH. The default direction of movement under the new system is toward ADAP, not toward AISH retention.

### **Observation 2: The numerical relationship between the split and the base benefit cut**

The base monthly benefit difference between ADAP (\$1,740) and AISH (\$1,940) is \$200/month, or \$2,400/year. Applied to 50,000 transitioning recipients after the December 31, 2027 transition benefit ends, the annualized benefit reduction is approximately \$120 million per year. This calculation is provided for documentary completeness; it does not account for employment income changes, child benefit recalibration, the 88 per cent cohabitation reduction, or other regulatory effects, all of which interact with the base figure.

### **Observation 3: The split was not in the August 2025 consultation**

The August 2025 Discussion Guide invited Albertans to comment on the proposed framework, eligibility criteria, benefit rates, and transition approach. It did not include population estimates by program. Participants in the consultation could not know what proportion of AISH recipients would be transitioned versus retained. The figure was published after the consultation concluded.

## 5. The Auto-Stay-On-AISH Criteria

The May 12 release confirms the four categories of current AISH recipients who will automatically remain on AISH after July 1, 2026, unless they choose to transition to ADAP to access the higher employment income exemptions. These criteria are now locked in regulation.

| Category                                     | Definition (per May 12 materials)                                                                                                                                        |
|----------------------------------------------|--------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Severe and profound developmental disability | Individuals with a severe and profound developmental disability, or who are deemed eligible for or are receiving Persons with Developmental Disabilities (PDD) services. |
| Palliative or terminal medical conditions    | Individuals with palliative or terminal medical conditions.                                                                                                              |
| Continuing care residency                    | Individuals living in continuing care homes.                                                                                                                             |
| Age 60 or older                              | Individuals 60 years of age or older.                                                                                                                                    |

Source: ADAP Fact Sheet, [alberta.ca](http://alberta.ca), May 12, 2026; [alberta.ca](http://alberta.ca) ADAP page, accessed May 16, 2026.

Per the May 12 release: “Current AISH clients who meet the criteria for automatic approval for AISH do not need to take any action – they will be identified by AISH and notified prior to July 2026.” All current AISH recipients are scheduled to receive letters in mid-May 2026 indicating which program they will be on as of July 1, 2026.

### What the criteria do not include

Several categories of severe and persistent disability do not appear in the auto-stay criteria. These include severe mental illness without an associated developmental disability diagnosis, severe chronic pain conditions, severe autoimmune conditions, severe and persistent psychiatric disability, and severe progressive conditions that have not yet been classified as palliative or terminal. Individuals in these categories whose disability has been previously accepted as qualifying for AISH will, by default, be transitioned to ADAP unless they apply for AISH reassessment after July 1, 2026.

The government covers the cost of one medical assessment for current AISH clients who transition to ADAP and later request to be reassessed for AISH. This coverage is not time-limited.

## 6. The Appeal Architecture and Appellate Compensation Record

The May 12 release confirms a three-body appeal structure that supplements what was previously a single-channel structure through the Citizen's Appeal Panel. This section documents the structural change, identifies the loss of appellate review on AISH Medical Review Panel decisions, and places the existing Citizen's Appeal Panel's six-year compensation disclosure on the public record.

| Body                                      | What it hears (per May 12 release)                                                                                                                                                                        |
|-------------------------------------------|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Citizen's Appeal Panel (continuing)       | Non-medical eligibility appeals (e.g., financial eligibility, general eligibility, residency). Continues to hear appeals under AISH, IES, FSCD, PDD, CC, SB, ELCC, CYFE, PPC, AADL, and MHSP legislation. |
| ADAP Medical Appeal Panel (new)           | Appeals of decisions by the disability assistance adjudicator not to refer an application to the AISH Medical Review Panel. Also hears appeals of decisions denying ADAP eligibility.                     |
| AISH Medical Review Panel (new structure) | Final determination of medical eligibility for AISH. Per the August 2025 Discussion Guide and confirmed in the May 12 materials, AISH Medical Review Panel decisions are not appealable.                  |

Sources: [alberta.ca/alberta-disability-assistance-program](https://alberta.ca/alberta-disability-assistance-program) (accessed May 16, 2026); [alberta.ca/citizens-appeal-panel](https://alberta.ca/citizens-appeal-panel) (accessed May 16, 2026); [alss-transforming-disability-income-assistance-discussion-guide.pdf](#) (August 2025).

The Citizen's Appeal Panel is described in its governing Alberta.ca materials as “an independent, quasi-judicial tribunal, committed to procedural fairness and the principles of natural justice in all its decisions.” Members are appointed through Ministerial Order for three-year terms, with reappointment possible up to a twelve-year maximum. Compensation disclosure for 2019 through 2024 is published under the Public Sector Compensation Transparency Act.

### Terminology shift between August 2025 and May 2026

In the August 2025 Discussion Guide and in Inclusion Alberta's August 2025 analysis, the new body hearing ADAP-related medical eligibility questions was referred to as the “ADAP Medical Review Panel.” In the May 12 release and the live alberta.ca page accessed May 16, 2026, the same body is consistently referred to as the “ADAP Medical Appeal Panel.” The change in nomenclature is documented here without characterization of intent.

### Loss of appellate review on AISH Medical Review Panel decisions

The August 2025 Discussion Guide states explicitly: “The AISH Medical Review Panel's decisions are not appealable.” The May 12 release and the live alberta.ca page do not amend this position. Per Inclusion Alberta's analysis of the Discussion Guide:

*“Limiting the right to appeal eligibility is concerning. Adjudicators only refer files to the Medical Review Panel, which then makes a binding decision. It appears that applicants do not get to present their case to the panel.”*

Source: Inclusion Alberta, *Understanding the proposed changes to AISH, the new Alberta Disability Assistance Program (ADAP), and suggestions on how to respond to the ADAP survey*, August 2025, p. 9.

Per the published government materials, an applicant denied for AISH by the AISH Medical Review Panel remains in the ADAP program. There is no published right to a hearing before the Medical Review Panel makes its determination. There is no published right to appeal that determination after it is made. By contrast, ADAP eligibility decisions and adjudicator decisions to not refer to the AISH Medical Review Panel are appealable to the new ADAP Medical Appeal Panel. The structural effect is that an applicant has appellate review on the way to AISH but not at the determination point.

### Citizen’s Appeal Panel: six-year compensation record (2019–2024)

Under the *Public Sector Compensation Transparency Act*, the Citizen’s Appeal Panel publishes annual compensation disclosure for its members. The disclosure file released by the Government of Alberta covers fiscal years 2019 through 2024 and contains 604 individual member-year records. The aggregate figures by year are reproduced below.

| Year                | Members Compensated | Total Compensation  | Average per Member |
|---------------------|---------------------|---------------------|--------------------|
| 2019                | 112                 | \$2,686,558         | \$23,987           |
| 2020                | 102                 | \$2,004,336         | \$19,650           |
| 2021                | 106                 | \$1,978,890         | \$18,669           |
| 2022                | 105                 | \$2,316,220         | \$22,059           |
| 2023                | 92                  | \$2,025,852         | \$22,020           |
| 2024                | 87                  | \$2,094,643         | \$24,076           |
| <b>6-year total</b> | <b>n/a</b>          | <b>\$13,106,499</b> | <b>\$21,734</b>    |

Source: *Citizen’s Appeal Panel compensation disclosure file*, Government of Alberta, published under the *Public Sector Compensation Transparency Act*, downloaded May 17, 2026. Filename: *citizens-appeal-panel-compensation-disclosure.csv*.

Three observations from the six-year disclosure record:

- **Member count is declining.** The number of compensated members fell from 112 in 2019 to 87 in 2024 — a 22 per cent reduction. The Citizen’s Appeal Panel hears appeals under 11 statutes including AISH, PDD, FSCD, Continuing Care, Seniors Benefit, ELCC, CYFE, PPC, AADL, IES, and MHSP. The May 12, 2026 introduction of ADAP and the new ADAP Medical Appeal Panel adds a parallel appeals body without reversing the membership decline at CAP.

- **Total six-year compensation is approximately \$13.1 million.** Members receive honoraria for time spent on CAP business and reimbursement for travel expenses per government policy. Per the Alberta.ca CAP page, members are not Government of Alberta employees; they are appointed through Ministerial Order for three-year terms with reappointment possible up to twelve years.
- **Top earner compensation in 2024 was \$108,479.** The highest single-year compensation in the disclosure period was \$138,568 (Chair, 2019). Provincial Chair compensation in 2024 was \$53,292 (Ortt, S.); Vice-Chair compensation ranged from \$44,548 to \$94,761 in 2024. These figures are documented compensation paid to individual tribunal members under the existing single-channel structure.

### **What the disclosure does not contain**

The Citizen's Appeal Panel compensation disclosure file is the only publicly available compensation record for the tribunal infrastructure around disability income assistance appeals in Alberta. As of May 16, 2026, no compensation disclosure has been published for either the AISH Medical Review Panel or the ADAP Medical Appeal Panel because both bodies become operational July 1, 2026. The first compensation disclosure for these bodies, if they fall under the *Public Sector Compensation Transparency Act*, would be expected by June 30, 2027 for the fiscal year 2026 partial year, with first full-year disclosure in June 2028.

## 7. The Transition Cliff: December 31, 2027

The \$200 monthly transition benefit that keeps an AISH-to-ADAP recipient at their existing AISH dollar amount is time-limited. The transition benefit expires December 31, 2027.

| Period                                               | Effective monthly base benefit (single recipient)                                                                         |
|------------------------------------------------------|---------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Currently (until June 30, 2026)                      | AISH: \$1,940                                                                                                             |
| July 1, 2026 – December 31, 2027 (transition period) | AISH recipients: \$1,940   AISH-to-ADAP recipients: \$1,740 + \$200 = \$1,940                                             |
| January 1, 2028 onward                               | AISH recipients: \$1,940 (annual indexed adjustments apply)   ADAP recipients: \$1,740 (annual indexed adjustments apply) |

Source: [alberta.ca ADAP page](#); [ADAP Fact Sheet](#); [alss-transforming-disability-income-assistance-discussion-guide.pdf](#) (Discussion Topic #5, p. 25).

Three operational implications follow directly from the cliff date:

- **Eighteen months of transition coverage.** For an AISH recipient transitioning to ADAP on July 1, 2026, the transition benefit covers approximately 18 months (July 2026 through December 2027). The recipient is on ADAP eligibility rules during this period, with a top-up that preserves their dollar amount.
- **The cliff applies to all transitioning recipients simultaneously.** There is no staggered phase-out. All approximately 50,000 transitioning recipients receive their final \$1,940 ADAP-equivalent payment in December 2027 and their first \$1,740 standalone ADAP payment in January 2028, subject to annual indexed adjustments effective January 1 each year.
- **New applicants do not receive the transition benefit.** Per Inclusion Alberta's August 2025 analysis and confirmed in the May 12 materials, an individual who applies for disability income assistance on or after July 1, 2026 (for example, someone turning 18 on or after that date who qualifies for ADAP) receives the \$1,740 ADAP base benefit without the \$200 transition top-up.

## 8. Contestable Claims on the Public Record

The May 12, 2026 release and accompanying materials contain a number of factual claims about ADAP relative to comparable programs and relative to the consultation process. The contestable claims below are placed on the public record without imputation of intent. Each is paired with the publicly documentable consideration that affects its evaluation.

### **Claim 1: “ADAP’s core benefit rate is among the highest in the country, providing \$300 more per month than most disability programs in Canada.”**

*Source: ADAP Fact Sheet, alberta.ca, May 12, 2026, p. 1.*

**Consideration on record:** The comparison made is to *other provincial disability income support programs*. The comparison not made in the same sentence is to *the Assured Income for the Severely Handicapped program, the existing benefit currently received by the approximately 50,000 Albertans who will be transitioned to ADAP*. At \$1,740, ADAP’s base benefit is \$200 lower per month, or \$2,400 lower per year, than the AISH benefit those 50,000 Albertans currently receive. For Albertans transitioning from AISH to ADAP, the relevant comparison is to AISH, not to comparable programs elsewhere.

### **Claim 2: “Albertans on ADAP will be able to earn up to \$45,240 annually in employment income while continuing to receive financial benefits. This will be the highest limit for employment income while receiving financial benefits of any comparable disability income assistance program in Canada.”**

*Source: ADAP Fact Sheet, alberta.ca, May 12, 2026, p. 2.*

**Consideration on record:** The annual employment income limit is verifiable. What is not specified in the same materials is the clawback rate as employment income approaches the \$45,000 figure. Per the published language: “Employment income above \$700 per month will be gradually deducted starting with less than a cent per dollar and *increasing significantly approaching \$45,000 employment income per year*.” Inclusion Alberta’s August 2025 analysis, citing economist Gillian Petit’s modeling based on Discussion Guide case studies, characterized the upper tier of the clawback schedule as approaching 100 per cent. The highest ceiling and the highest effective clawback near that ceiling can both be true.

### **Claim 3: “ADAP was thoughtfully designed based on input from Albertans with disabilities.”**

*Source: ADAP Fact Sheet, alberta.ca, May 12, 2026, p. 1; alberta.ca ADAP page, accessed May 16, 2026.*

**Consideration on record:** The August 2025 Discussion Guide and the public engagement that followed concluded in March 2026. Inclusion Alberta, the province’s largest family-based disability advocacy federation, stated publicly on August 18, 2025 that ADAP “could leave thousands with disabilities in deeper poverty” and called for redesign. Inclusion Lethbridge stated on May 16, 2026 that “fundamental aspects of the ADAP program remain deeply concerning” and that “people with disabilities should not be legislated into poverty.” Municipal councils in Edmonton, Calgary, Red Deer, Camrose, Lethbridge, and Medicine Hat have passed or moved motions urging the province to pause the implementation. The disability community’s public position on the design, as documented through community-led organizations and media, is not supportive. The May 12 release does not name any disability-led organization that has publicly endorsed the design as released.



**Claim 4: “We made a promise to Albertans to improve supports for persons with disabilities, and with the launch of ADAP, we’re delivering on that promise. To the thousands of Albertans with disabilities who have been overlooked for decades and will finally be able to receive the support they need from ADAP – we see you, we hear you, and help is coming this July.”**

*Source: Minister Jason Nixon, quoted in “Expanding support for Albertans with disabilities,” alberta.ca, May 12, 2026.*

**Consideration on record:** The statement implies that ADAP serves people previously unserved by AISH. The Minister’s press secretary, Amber Edgerton, characterized municipal criticism as “unfounded” in the *St. Albert Gazette* on May 11, 2026, stating that “municipalities are advocating against a program that will help thousands of Albertans with disabilities pursue meaningful employment.” The 50,000 Albertans being transitioned to ADAP are not previously unserved; they are current AISH recipients whose monthly benefit will be reduced by \$200 effective January 1, 2028. People who would newly qualify under ADAP’s lower medical-eligibility threshold could have been served by expanding AISH eligibility without changing the AISH benefit amount. The policy choice to use a structurally lower benefit to serve the new population is documented in the regulation as released; it is not a necessary feature of expanding service.

**Claim 5: “ADAP public engagement concluded March 2026. Thousands of Albertans participated in engagement via roundtables, telephone town halls, written submissions and an online survey.”**

*Source: alberta.ca/alberta-disability-assistance-program live page, accessed May 16, 2026; reasserted in ADAP Fact Sheet, May 12, 2026.*

**Consideration on record:** The Discussion Guide that anchored the engagement period was posted on August 13, 2025 and the engagement window ran through September 12, 2025. The Discussion Guide is real and the engagement was a real event, corroborated by independent third-party publications (Gillian Petit, Aug 15; Inclusion Alberta, Aug 18 and Aug 22; CBC News, Aug 21; Family-Centred Care Practice, Aug 26; Zachary Weeks, Sep 4). However, the dedicated alberta.ca engagement page that documents this engagement — [alberta.ca/alberta-disability-assistance-program-engagement](https://alberta.ca/alberta-disability-assistance-program-engagement) — has been forensically reconstructed from nine Wayback Machine snapshots spanning August 13, 2025 through April 12, 2026. The findings: (a) the page was rewritten from active engagement portal to retrospective archive within seven days of engagement closing — the “Get involved” section was deleted, the “Take the survey” link was removed, the body tense was changed from future to past, and a new “Input received” section was added; (b) the page’s stated survey end date was changed from September 12 (the Discussion Guide’s date and the date shown on the page in all active-version captures) to September 14, 2025 (the date shown in every retrospective-form capture and on today’s live page), without a public announcement of the extension located in the campaign’s research; (c) the page’s HTML metadata identifies October 2, 2025 as its publication date, and the October 21, 2025 Wayback capture shows a 3xx redirect consistent with URL routing instability during a CMS reorganization; (d) the retrospective version of the page remained materially unchanged for 206 days across six captures (Sep 19, 2025 – Apr 12, 2026), with the claim “Results are currently under review” maintained throughout — including for four months after Bill 12 passed using those very results; (e) the engagement page’s own internal News section never updated to reflect Bill 12 tabling, Bill 12 passing, or the March 24, 2026 budget announcement; (f) Wayback Machine captures of the URL stop on April 12, 2026; the current live page carries an explicit *noarchive* robots meta directive, and any modifications to the page after April 12, 2026 — including in response to the May 12, 2026 regulatory release — are not visible in the public archive. The full forensic record, with primary-source snapshot URLs and replication instructions, is documented in *The Engagement Page Record: A Forensic Timeline* (May 2026), the companion document to this analysis.



## 9. The OAPD Strategic Plan and the Endorsement Record

This section places three documents from the Office of the Advocate for Persons with Disabilities and the Government of Alberta side by side. The three documents are public. The dates are public. The wording reproduced below is verbatim or close paraphrase, with sources cited at each step. No motive is alleged. The relationship between the three documents is documented for the public record.

### Document A: February 4, 2025 ADAP Announcement

Greg McMeekin, Advocate for Persons with Disabilities, quoted in the February 4, 2025 alberta.ca news release announcing ADAP:

*"I strongly believe in empowering persons with disabilities to reach their full potential, and I also strongly believe that all people deserve to pursue their goals and aspirations without barriers. By creating this program, the province is making it easier for Albertans to find success. ADAP will truly help to improve the quality of life of persons with disabilities, and I look forward to seeing the positive impact of this new program."*

Source: alberta.ca news release, "Empowering Albertans with disabilities," February 4, 2025.

### Document B: October 2025 OAPD 2025–2027 Strategic Plan

Eight months after the ADAP endorsement, the Office of the Advocate for Persons with Disabilities publishes its *2025–2027 Strategic Plan* (ISBN 978-1-4601-6394-8). The strategic plan is a formal policy document. It identifies three strategic priorities. The second priority, on page 4, states:

#### Priority 2: Champion an Adequate Standard of Living

"Objective 2.1: Explore the experience of poverty among persons with disabilities and its connection to United Nations Convention on the Rights of Persons with Disabilities (UNCRPD) Article 28 (Adequate Standard of Living)."

"Objective 2.2: Review federal and provincial income support programs to identify gaps and recommend improvements."

Source: *Advocate for Persons with Disabilities 2025–2027 Strategic Plan*, Office of the Advocate for Persons with Disabilities, Government of Alberta, October 2025, p. 4.

Page 6 of the same document situates the priority in context:

“Adequate standard of living is rooted in the UNCRPD (Article 28). Albertans consistently report a lack of adequate standard of living to the OAPD. Persons with disabilities, especially those with severe disabilities, face higher poverty rates, and barriers to accessing food, clothing, housing, clean water, disability-related services, and income support programs.”

Source: OAPD 2025–2027 Strategic Plan, p. 6.

### **Document C: May 12, 2026 ADAP Regulations Confirmation**

Seven months after publication of the OAPD Strategic Plan, the Minister of Assisted Living and Social Services confirms the final ADAP regulations. Per the May 12 release and accompanying Fact Sheet, the regulations establish:

- Approximately 50,000 current AISH recipients will be transitioned to ADAP, with their base benefit reduced from \$1,940 to \$1,740 per month (less the \$200 transition top-up, which ends December 31, 2027).
- An 88 per cent cohabitation reduction will be applied to two-recipient households starting in the August 2026 benefit period, reducing each partner's benefit by approximately \$209–\$233 per month.
- A descending child benefit schedule (recalibrated against the federal Canada Child Benefit) will be applied beginning August 2026.
- All transitioned recipients who later seek to reapply for AISH retain only limited appeal rights, with AISH Medical Review Panel decisions stated as not appealable.

### **What the public record now shows**

In February 2025, the Office of the Advocate for Persons with Disabilities endorsed the ADAP program at announcement. In October 2025, the same office published a strategic plan committing the Advocate to championing an adequate standard of living anchored in UNCRPD Article 28 and to reviewing income support programs to identify gaps and recommend improvements. In May 2026, the endorsed program was confirmed in regulation, reducing the base benefit for approximately 50,000 Albertans — a population the OAPD Strategic Plan's own page 6 identifies as facing “higher poverty rates, and barriers to accessing food, clothing, housing, clean water, disability-related services, and income support programs.”

The OAPD Strategic Plan does not reference ADAP specifically. The three documents do not need to reference each other to form a record. They are published by the same office and minister, on a related subject matter, within a fifteen-month period. They are placed side by side here for documentary purposes. Whether the strategic plan's commitments have been or will be applied to the ADAP regulation is, on the public record as of May 16, 2026, an open question.

Under the *Advocate for Persons with Disabilities Act*, 2018, the Advocate's functions include "identifying and studying issues affecting persons with disabilities", "reviewing programs and policies", and "providing recommendations to the government." The OAPD's own published mission is "to help Albertans with disabilities get access to available supports and help them live with dignity and equal opportunities." The May 12, 2026 ADAP regulation is the single largest disability income assistance change since the establishment of AISH. Whether the Advocate has formally reviewed and provided recommendations on the regulation, consistent with the office's statutory function and its own published priorities, is documented here as an open question on the public record.

## 10. The Service Provider Economy: Mustard Seed Society Funding Pattern

The institutional context of the ADAP transition includes service providers that deliver downstream support to populations affected by the disability income assistance system. The Mustard Seed Society is one of the largest service providers operating in Alberta in this space. The Mustard Seed's audited financial statements for fiscal years 2018 through 2025 are publicly available; the funding pattern they document is reproduced here for the public record.

This is documentary. The Mustard Seed Society did not publicly endorse the ADAP design in February 2025 (the public endorsements named in the alberta.ca news release were from Prospect Human Services, Easter Seals Alberta Society, the Premier's Council for the Status of Persons with Disabilities, and the Office of the Advocate for Persons with Disabilities). The Mustard Seed data is reproduced here because emergency-services and downstream-support providers are the institutional bridge between income assistance policy and the lived consequences of that policy.

### Mustard Seed Society: grants and government funding, 2019–2025

| Fiscal Year (ended Mar 31) | Grants and Government Funding | Donations    | Total Annual Revenue (approx.) |
|----------------------------|-------------------------------|--------------|--------------------------------|
| FY 2020                    | \$8,374,558                   | \$17,735,414 | \$29,212,592                   |
| FY 2021                    | \$22,653,682                  | \$23,808,241 | \$49,922,650                   |
| FY 2022                    | \$24,842,669                  | \$23,394,140 | \$51,679,738                   |
| FY 2023                    | \$17,192,037                  | \$21,748,240 | \$42,704,975                   |
| FY 2024                    | \$25,837,831                  | \$23,536,217 | \$53,727,038                   |
| FY 2025                    | \$31,319,831                  | \$27,665,705 | \$64,206,173                   |

Source: *The Mustard Seed Society, Audited Combined Consolidated Financial Statements, FY 2018–FY 2025, signed by independent auditors and filed publicly. The Mustard Seed is registered as a Canadian charity. FY 2018–19 figures available in earlier comparative columns.*

Three observations from the seven-year audited record:

- **Government funding to The Mustard Seed has grown approximately 308 per cent** between FY 2019 (\$7,664,298, reported as comparative figure in the FY 2020 statements) and FY 2025 (\$31,319,831). This is a compound annual growth rate of approximately 26 per cent over the seven-year period.
- **Government funding represented approximately 48.8 per cent of total Mustard Seed revenue in FY 2025** — up from approximately 32 per cent of total revenue in FY 2020. The dependency relationship between this service provider and the provincial government has approximately doubled in share over five years.

- **The COVID-era funding surge has not reversed.** FY 2021 saw government funding to The Mustard Seed jump from \$8.4M to \$22.7M (+170 per cent year-over-year) and FY 2025 represents the highest funding level in the disclosed record. This pattern documents sustained and growing government investment in emergency and homelessness response services in Alberta — concurrent with the AISH-to-ADAP transition that will reduce monthly base income assistance for approximately 50,000 Albertans.

### **What this section documents and does not document**

This section places audited service-provider financial data on the public record. It does not allege any specific connection between Mustard Seed funding levels and ADAP policy. It does not characterize Mustard Seed's public positioning on ADAP. The Mustard Seed delivers emergency food, shelter, housing, and outreach services to populations including but not limited to Albertans on AISH. The financial pattern of growing reliance on government funding for emergency services concurrent with reductions in income assistance is documented here for the public record as a structural observation about how Alberta funds responses to disability and poverty.

## 11. External Analytical Voices Now on the Record

Several analytical voices have placed material on the public record between August 2025 and May 2026 that bears on the May 12 release. This section documents who has said what, with citations. No characterization of the voices' political views or affiliations is provided.

### Gillian Petit, economist

Economist Gillian Petit has published modeling of ADAP's clawback structure based on the case studies in the August 2025 Discussion Guide. Inclusion Alberta reproduces Petit's modeled clawback schedule as their best-available estimate of how the published case studies translate into a per-dollar clawback rate. The schedule is reproduced here as the modeled estimate it is, not as an officially confirmed government figure.

| Employment income tier (monthly) | Modeled clawback rate                                               |
|----------------------------------|---------------------------------------------------------------------|
| \$0 – \$350                      | Exempt (no clawback)                                                |
| \$350 – \$1,500                  | 15%                                                                 |
| \$1,500 – \$2,500                | 41%                                                                 |
| \$2,500 – \$3,000                | 82%                                                                 |
| \$3,000 – \$3,750                | 100%                                                                |
| Above \$3,750                    | Recipient retains health benefits; no remaining ADAP income support |

*Source: Inclusion Alberta, "Understanding the proposed changes to AISH, the new ADAP, and suggestions on how to respond to the ADAP survey," August 2025, citing Gillian Petit's independent analysis. Petit's blog is referenced by Inclusion Alberta.*

Per Inclusion Alberta's analysis of Petit's case-study modeling: to be better off on ADAP than on the current AISH program, a recipient needs to earn approximately \$25,368 per year from employment — equivalent to approximately 33 hours per week at minimum wage. Below that earning threshold, the recipient is worse off on ADAP than on the AISH program as it currently exists.

### Inclusion Alberta

Inclusion Alberta is a family-based, non-profit federation that advocates on behalf of children and adults with intellectual disabilities and their families. The organization holds Canadian Revenue Agency charitable number 10669 2593 RR0001. Inclusion Alberta has made the following statements on the public record:

*“This is a devastating blow to people with disabilities on AISH. They will see their income decreased based on the assumption that with a little job training, they will be able to secure and maintain sufficient employment. There is nothing proposed here that will address complex and deep-rooted systemic barriers and materially change the longstanding 80% unemployment rate for adults with intellectual disabilities. This is simply going to drive Albertans with disabilities deeper into poverty and despair.” —*  
Trish Bowman, CEO of Inclusion Alberta

Source: Inclusion Alberta media release, August 18, 2025.

Inclusion Alberta has called publicly for the redesign of ADAP. As of May 16, 2026, that call remains on the public record. Inclusion Alberta’s 23-page analytical guide, *Understanding the proposed changes to AISH, the new Alberta Disability Assistance Program (ADAP), and suggestions on how to respond to the ADAP survey*, provides item-by-item analysis of the August 2025 Discussion Guide.

## Inclusion Lethbridge

Inclusion Lethbridge published a letter to the editor in the *Lethbridge Herald* on May 16, 2026, signed by Rene Plaizier, Executive Director, and Katrina Neil, President of the Board of Directors:

*“Determining income support based primarily on employability does not reflect the realities many people with disabilities face every day... People on ADAP will receive a maximum of \$1,740 as base income, while people on AISH will receive \$1,940 as base income (both figures include any eligible Canada Disability Benefit). Note that both of these maximum amounts are well below the Market Basket Measure for a city the size of Lethbridge in Alberta which works out to approximately \$2,205 per month for a single person. We don’t believe that people with disabilities should be legislated into poverty.”*

Source: *Lethbridge Herald*, May 16, 2026.

## Jon Auger

Jon Auger is an Alberta-based writer who publishes on Substack at [jonauger.substack.com](https://jonauger.substack.com). Auger has placed three pieces on the public record in the week of May 11–19, 2026, directly addressing the ADAP transition.

- *“You Can Earn Your Way Into Inclusion”* — published May 16, 2026. Connects Premier Smith’s April 2026 statement on “earning inclusion” in the school context to the ADAP transition’s structural reorientation of disability support around “residual labour capacity rather than stable recognition of medically established limitation.”
- *“When the Floor Disappears”* — published May 18, 2026. A long-form essay on the lived reality of disability under means-tested income support, framed as a thought experiment about what would happen if a policymaker were forced into the system they currently govern.
- *“Love Now Comes With a Clawback”* — published May 19, 2026. Specifically addresses the 88 per cent cohabitation reduction and the spousal employment income exemption changes. Calculates the 12 per cent reduction as approximately \$232.80 per partner per month at AISH rates.

On May 14, 2026, Auger also published a public Facebook description of the Alberta Disability System Breakdown project, framing the project's documentary scope through Johan Galtung's concept of structural violence.



## 12. Municipal Coalition Status (as of May 16, 2026)

Municipal governments in Alberta have, as of May 16, 2026, taken or moved formal action regarding the ADAP transition. The status below is documentary and reflects publicly reported positions.

| Municipality | Public Position / Action                                                                                                      |
|--------------|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Calgary      | Council has called on the province regarding ADAP impacts.                                                                    |
| Edmonton     | Council has called on the province regarding ADAP impacts.                                                                    |
| Red Deer     | Council has called on the province to pause ADAP and undertake meaningful consultation; reported May 13, 2026.                |
| Camrose      | Reported by <i>St. Albert Gazette</i> as having passed or being in discussion to pass a similar motion.                       |
| Lethbridge   | Inclusion Lethbridge has published an open letter; municipal action documented in coalition record.                           |
| Medicine Hat | In coalition coordination per campaign record.                                                                                |
| St. Albert   | Coun. Amanda Patrick submitted notice of motion; council vote scheduled May 19, 2026. Hometown municipality of this campaign. |

Sources: *St. Albert Gazette*, May 11, 2026 (Tristan Oram); *Red Deer Advocate*, May 13, 2026 (Susan Zielinski); *Lethbridge Herald*, May 16, 2026 (Inclusion Lethbridge open letter); campaign coalition record.

On May 11, 2026, in response to municipal action, Amber Edgerton, press secretary for the Minister of Assisted Living and Social Services, told the *St. Albert Gazette* that the criticism was “unfounded” and that “municipalities are advocating against a program that will help thousands of Albertans with disabilities pursue meaningful employment.”

Local food bank executive director Suzan Krecsy, quoted in the same *St. Albert Gazette* piece, said the St. Albert Food Bank is “bracing for an increase in food bank usage now and a possible increase in evictions as people may no longer be able to meet their rent.”

## 13. Community Voice on the Record

The May 12 release is being received by approximately 80,000 Albertans currently on AISH, their households, and their support networks. The voices below have been placed on the public record through journalism, open letters, and Substack publishing in the week of May 11–19, 2026. They are reproduced as documented.

### From the *Red Deer Advocate*, May 13, 2026

Red Deer AISH recipient Crystal, who had not yet received a letter about her eligibility to remain on AISH at the time of the article, told Susan Zielinski:

*"If we wanted this, why would we be fighting it? It's not as easy to get a job. I've been fired multiple times because of having a disability... They should just leave [AISH] the way it is. People that wanted to work, could work."*

Source: *Red Deer Advocate*, May 13, 2026.

### From Coun. Amanda Patrick, St. Albert

*"The City of St. Albert should follow the lead of other municipalities and show our disabled community that we support them, that we understand the added stress and anxiety, and financial stress that this program could potentially have on them... I just think we should be showing support to our disabled community."*

Source: *St. Albert Gazette*, May 11, 2026.

### From Barbara Nish, Inclusion Alberta

*"From the 1970s when my son with intellectual disabilities was born until today, I've never witnessed such a recurrent pattern of government decisions that harm people with disabilities. It's beyond comprehension that MLAs would raise their housing allowance by \$270 to \$2,200 per month while cutting \$200 from people with disabilities—three times in a row."*

Source: Barbara Nish, Vice President, Inclusion Alberta, in Inclusion Alberta media release, August 18, 2025.

### Public commentary on the *St. Albert Gazette* article

The article also collected reader comments. The selection below documents the community-facing register, not editorial endorsement.

*"This government needs to give their heads a shake. Like most things, they haven't consulted with disability groups, hence why advocates are protesting this decision."* — Leah Aych, May 11, 2026, 7:16 PM

*"The most vulnerable of our population count on the municipalities to look out for them."* — Cheryl Brodgesell, May 11, 2026, 7:56 PM

*"All this government does is strips vulnerable people of their needs."* — Jack McMurphy, May 13, 2026, 11:51 AM

Source: *St. Albert Gazette* comments section, May 11–13, 2026.

## 14. Adjacent Community-Led Documentation Work

Several community-led documentation efforts have emerged in parallel to address aspects of the disability system in Alberta that intersect with but are not solely about the ADAP transition. These efforts are catalogued here because they form part of the community evidentiary infrastructure available to Albertans navigating disability-related programs as of May 2026.

### Kristina Koivisto — PDD C2N2 Referral Pathway Family Guide

Kristina Koivisto (TeamMason2021) has published a family-led guide and checklist titled *PDD C2N2 Referral Pathway – Family Guide & Checklist*, dated 2026. The document explains the Complex Needs Network (C2N2) referral pathway used within PDD service coordination to access Occupational Therapy, Speech-Language Pathology, behavioural assessments, risk assessments, and functional/adaptive behaviour evaluations.

Per the guide: “Many families are never clearly told this pathway exists. I created a simple printable guide/checklist explaining what C2N2 is, how to request referrals, how complex needs supports are coordinated, and why these assessments matter for accurate Outcome Plans and funding support.”

Source: PDD Alberta – Family Access & Reality (Facebook group), and *C2N2\_PDD\_Family\_Guide\_Checklist.pdf*, © 2026 Kristina Koivisto — TeamMason2021.

### Pete Klassen

Pete Klassen is an independent disability advocate active in Alberta. Klassen has worked with the Alberta Disability System Breakdown campaign as a collaborator on framing documents addressing neurodivergence and intellectual disability. Klassen’s work intersects with but is not specific to the ADAP transition.

### Why this section exists

The community of family advocates, independent advocates, and community-led documentation efforts is broader than any single campaign or organization. This document is part of that ecosystem; so are the works named above. The cataloging is non-exhaustive; the purpose is to record that the community evidentiary base extends beyond the formal advocacy organizations named in Section 11.

## 15. The Legislative Substrate

The Alberta Disability Assistance Program does not exist as a standalone program. It operates within a substrate of provincial statutes and regulations, federal-provincial coordination frameworks, and international human rights instruments to which Canada is a State Party. This section documents the principal elements of that substrate as they bear on the May 12, 2026 release.

### Provincial statutes and regulations (Alberta King's Printer)

Office Consolidations published by the Alberta King's Printer for the principal statutes and regulations governing disability income assistance, developmental disability services, mental health services, child and family supports, continuing care, seniors' benefits, and the compensation transparency framework are listed below. All are publicly available; all are current as of December 18, 2025 or later (most recent edition consulted).

| Statute / Regulation                                       | Scope and ADAP Relevance                                                                                                                                                                                            |
|------------------------------------------------------------|---------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Assured Income for the Severely Handicapped Act (AISH)     | Establishes AISH program. ADAP is being introduced alongside AISH via regulation under this Act and the AISH General Regulation, which the May 12 release confirms has been updated to apply to both AISH and ADAP. |
| Mental Health Services Protection Act (and Regulation)     | Governs mental health services delivery. Citizen's Appeal Panel hears appeals under this Act. Relevant for ADAP applicants whose disability is psychiatric in nature.                                               |
| Persons with Developmental Disabilities Services Act (PDD) | Governs PDD services. Per May 12 release, individuals deemed eligible for or receiving PDD services are in the auto-stay-on-AISH category.                                                                          |
| Family Support for Children with Disabilities Act (FSCD)   | Governs FSCD program. Citizen's Appeal Panel hears FSCD appeals.                                                                                                                                                    |
| Income and Employment Supports Act (IES) and regulations   | Governs general income support. Albertans determined not to meet ADAP or AISH medical eligibility may be referred to IES.                                                                                           |
| Continuing Care Act and Regulation                         | Governs continuing care residency. Per May 12 release, individuals living in continuing care homes are in the auto-stay-on-AISH category.                                                                           |
| Seniors Benefit Act and General Regulation                 | Governs seniors' benefits. Per May 12 release, individuals 60 years of age or older are in the auto-stay-on-AISH category.                                                                                          |
| Protection for Persons in Care Act and Regulation          | Governs protective oversight for vulnerable Albertans in care settings. Citizen's Appeal Panel hears appeals under this Act.                                                                                        |
| Child, Youth and Family Enhancement Act (and Regulations)  | Governs child welfare. Includes the Resource Rebate Regulation and Adoption Regulation. Relevant for households where dependent children and disability supports intersect.                                         |

|                                                                    |                                                                                                                           |
|--------------------------------------------------------------------|---------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Child Care Act, Early Learning and Child Care Act                  | Govern child care provision. Relevant for ADAP parent recipients.                                                         |
| Public Sector Compensation Transparency Act and General Regulation | Establishes the disclosure framework under which the Citizen's Appeal Panel compensation record (Section 6) is published. |

Source: Office Consolidations published by Alberta King's Printer. Acts and regulations are current as of December 18, 2025 (or most recent edition). Full text available from [kings-printer.alberta.ca](https://kings-printer.alberta.ca).

## International framework: UN Convention on the Rights of Persons with Disabilities (CRPD)

Canada signed the Convention on the Rights of Persons with Disabilities and its Optional Protocol on March 30, 2007. Canada ratified the Convention on March 11, 2010. The Convention entered into force on May 3, 2008. As of the disclosure period, the Convention has 193 ratifications/accessions and 164 signatories.

Article 28 of the Convention — cited by name in the Office of the Advocate for Persons with Disabilities' 2025–2027 Strategic Plan (see Section 9 of this document) — states in full:

### Article 28 — Adequate standard of living and social protection

1. States Parties recognize the right of persons with disabilities to an adequate standard of living for themselves and their families, including adequate food, clothing and housing, and to the continuous improvement of living conditions, and shall take appropriate steps to safeguard and promote the realization of this right without discrimination on the basis of disability.

2. States Parties recognize the right of persons with disabilities to social protection and to the enjoyment of that right without discrimination on the basis of disability, and shall take appropriate steps to safeguard and promote the realization of this right, including measures:

- (a) To ensure equal access by persons with disabilities to clean water services, and to ensure access to appropriate and affordable services, devices and other assistance for disability-related needs;
- (b) To ensure access by persons with disabilities, in particular women and girls with disabilities and older persons with disabilities, to social protection programmes and poverty reduction programmes;
- (c) To ensure access by persons with disabilities and their families living in situations of poverty to assistance from the State with disability-related expenses, including adequate training, counselling, financial assistance and respite care;
- (d) To ensure access by persons with disabilities to public housing programmes;
- (e) To ensure equal access by persons with disabilities to retirement benefits and programmes.

Source: *Convention on the Rights of Persons with Disabilities*, United Nations, opened for signature March 30, 2007.

## Institutional precedent: 2016 PDD Safety Standards Consultation

The 2016 *Supporting Safe and Inclusive Lives* report (Report of the Persons with Developmental Disabilities Safety Standards Consultation 2016, Plain Language Version), chaired by John te Linde, established a documented framework in Alberta for how disability-affected populations are consulted on policies that affect

them. The 2016 consultation included multi-phase engagement with hundreds of community members and resulted in eleven recommendations.

The institutional precedent matters as a benchmark. The August 2025 ADAP Discussion Guide consultation period, including the public survey and the two government telephone town halls in September 2025, ran on a substantially compressed timeline relative to the 2016 PDD Safety Standards process. The 2016 process is referenced here as a documentary precedent for what “designed based on input from Albertans with disabilities” has historically required in Alberta.

## Closing: What the Record Shows

The week of May 11–16, 2026 closed a fifteen-month consultation and regulatory development period that began with the February 4, 2025 announcement of the Alberta Disability Assistance Program. As of May 16, 2026, the public record contains:

- A confirmed split of approximately 50,000 transitioning current AISH recipients to ADAP and approximately 30,000 auto-staying on AISH, effective July 1, 2026.
- A base ADAP monthly benefit of \$1,740, with a \$200 transition benefit expiring December 31, 2027 — producing a \$200/month effective reduction for approximately 50,000 Albertans starting January 1, 2028.
- A new 88 per cent cohabitation reduction affecting two-recipient households, introduced through regulation after the consultation period.
- A descending child benefit schedule explicitly framed as recalibrated against the federal Canada Child Benefit.
- An OAPD Strategic Plan committing the Advocate's office to championing UNCRPD Article 28 (Adequate Standard of Living) and reviewing income support programs to identify gaps — published between the Advocate's endorsement of ADAP and the regulation that confirms it.
- A coalition of Alberta municipalities — Calgary, Edmonton, Red Deer, Camrose, Lethbridge, Medicine Hat, and St. Albert — that has passed or moved formal motions urging the province to pause the implementation.
- Published analytical work from Inclusion Alberta and economist Gillian Petit indicating that the financial break-even point for ADAP recipients is approximately \$25,368 per year in employment income.
- Community and analytical voices on the public record characterizing the design as inconsistent with the consultation responses received.
- A documented forensic record of the alberta.ca engagement page covering the August–September 2025 ADAP consultation, reconstructed from nine Wayback Machine snapshots: the page was rewritten from active engagement portal to retrospective archive within seven days of engagement closing; the page's stated survey end date was changed from September 12 (per the Discussion Guide and all active-version captures) to September 14, 2025 without a located public announcement of the extension; the retrospective version remained materially unchanged for 206 days through Bill 12 tabling, Bill 12 passing, and the March 2026 budget announcement; and the page has been suppressed from public archiving since April 12, 2026 via a *noarchive* robots meta directive. Documented separately in *The Engagement Page Record: A Forensic Timeline* (May 2026).
- A documented 308 per cent increase in Government of Alberta funding to one major service provider (The Mustard Seed Society) over the seven-year period FY 2019 to FY 2025, concurrent with the policy decisions that reduce upstream income assistance.
- A documented six-year compensation record for the Citizen's Appeal Panel (approximately \$13.1 million across 2019–2024) and a confirmed loss of appellate review on AISH Medical Review Panel determinations under the new structure.
- An international human rights framework — the UN Convention on the Rights of Persons with Disabilities, to which Canada is a State Party — whose Article 28 establishes the right of persons with disabilities to an adequate standard of living and social protection without discrimination.



This document does not allege motive. It does not characterize intent. It places three categories of material side by side: what the Government of Alberta has published, what the Government of Alberta's own offices have committed to, and what external analytical and community voices have placed on the public record in response. The relationships among those three categories are documented here.

On July 1, 2026, the AISH-to-ADAP transition will become operational. The record as of May 16, 2026 is the record this document preserves.

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### **The Alberta Disability System Breakdown — Advocate**

St. Albert, Alberta | May 2026

[albertadisabilitybreakdown@outlook.com](mailto:albertadisabilitybreakdown@outlook.com)

## Sources Referenced in This Document

All sources below are published, publicly accessible documents. URLs are provided where the source is online. Citations are organized by category.

### Government of Alberta (primary sources)

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- Government of Alberta, *Transforming Disability Income Assistance in Alberta: Discussion Guide*, Assisted Living and Social Services, August 2025 (filename: alss-transforming-disability-income-assistance-discussion-guide.pdf).
- Office of the Advocate for Persons with Disabilities, *2025–2027 Strategic Plan*, October 2025, ISBN 978-1-4601-6394-8 (filename: alss-oapd-advocate-for-persons-with-disabilities-2025-2027-strategic-plan.pdf).
- alberta.ca, “Expanding support for Albertans with disabilities,” May 12, 2026 (URL: alberta.ca/release.cfm?xID=961712F562B26-03A4-92BA-9D29D2A5BD5C37C3).
- Government of Alberta, ADAP Fact Sheet (filename: alss-adap-fact-sheet.pdf), Assisted Living and Social Services, May 12, 2026.
- alberta.ca/alberta-disability-assistance-program (live page), accessed May 16, 2026.
- alberta.ca/citizens-appeal-panel and alberta.ca/about-the-citizens-appeal-panel, accessed May 16, 2026.
- Citizen’s Appeal Panel compensation disclosure, 2019–2024, published under the *Public Sector Compensation Transparency Act*.

### Disability advocacy organizations

- Inclusion Alberta, “Alberta Disability Assistance Program (ADAP) Could Leave Thousands with Disabilities in Deeper Poverty” (media release), August 18, 2025. URL: inclusionalberta.org/connections/media-release-alberta-disability-assistance-program-adap-could-leave-thousands-with-disabilities-in-deeper-poverty.
- Inclusion Alberta, *Understanding the proposed changes to AISH, the new Alberta Disability Assistance Program (ADAP), and suggestions on how to respond to the ADAP survey*, August 2025 (23-page guide).
- Inclusion Lethbridge (Rene Plaizier and Katrina Neil), letter to the editor, *Lethbridge Herald*, May 16, 2026.

### Independent analytical work

- Gillian Petit, economist. Clawback modeling cited and reproduced by Inclusion Alberta in their August 2025 analysis. Petit’s independent blog and writing are referenced by Inclusion Alberta as the source of the clawback tier estimates reproduced in Section 10.
- Jon Auger, *My Thoughts* Substack, jonauger.substack.com. Three pieces from May 16, May 18, and May 19, 2026 directly addressing ADAP.

## Media coverage

- Tristan Oram, “St. Albert to discuss asking province to pause disability support program,” *St. Albert Gazette*, May 11, 2026. URL: [stalbertgazette.com/local-news/st-albert-to-discuss-asking-province-to-pause-adap-12257690](https://stalbertgazette.com/local-news/st-albert-to-discuss-asking-province-to-pause-adap-12257690).
- Susan Zielinski, “Disabled Albertans to receive letters this month about their AISH eligibility,” *Red Deer Advocate*, May 13, 2026.

## Companion documents in the Alberta Disability System Breakdown record

- The Alberta Disability System Breakdown, *The Engagement Page Record: A Forensic Timeline*, May 2026. Standalone evidentiary record on the alberta.ca ADAP engagement page from August 2025 through May 2026, reconstructed from nine Wayback Machine snapshots. Documents the active-to-retrospective rewrite (Sep 12–19, 2025), the survey end date change (Sep 12 → Sep 14), the 206-day frozen retrospective period through legislative milestones, and the April 12, 2026 onward archive blackout. Companion to Section 8 Claim 5 of this document.

## Service-provider audited financial statements

- The Mustard Seed Society, Audited Combined Consolidated Financial Statements, fiscal years ended March 31, 2018 through March 31, 2025. Filed by independent auditors as required for registered Canadian charities. Eight audit cycles in the public record provide the data summarized in Section 10.

## Provincial statutes and regulations (Alberta King’s Printer)

- *Assured Income for the Severely Handicapped Act* and AISH General Regulation (updated 2025 to apply to both AISH and ADAP); *Mental Health Services Protection Act* and Regulation; *Persons with Developmental Disabilities Services Act*; *Family Support for Children with Disabilities Act* and Regulation; *Income and Employment Supports Act* and Regulations; *Continuing Care Act* and Regulation; *Seniors Benefit Act* and General Regulation; *Protection for Persons in Care Act* and Regulation; *Child, Youth and Family Enhancement Act* and Regulations (including Adoption Regulation and Resource Rebate Regulation); *Child Care Act*; *Early Learning and Child Care Act*; *Public Sector Compensation Transparency Act* and General Regulation. All Office Consolidations published by Alberta King's Printer, current as of December 18, 2025 or most recent edition.

## International human rights instruments

- United Nations, *Convention on the Rights of Persons with Disabilities* (CRPD), adopted December 13, 2006; opened for signature March 30, 2007; entered into force May 3, 2008. Canada signed March 30, 2007 and ratified March 11, 2010. Article 28: Adequate Standard of Living and Social Protection.
- United Nations, *Optional Protocol to the Convention on the Rights of Persons with Disabilities*, opened for signature March 30, 2007.

## Adjacent community-led documentation

- Kristina Koivisto (TeamMason2021), *PDD C2N2 Referral Pathway — Family Guide & Checklist*, 2026. Published via the PDD Alberta — Family Access & Reality community.
- Pete Klassen, independent disability advocate, Alberta. Collaborator on framing materials addressing neurodivergence and intellectual disability in the broader Alberta disability advocacy ecosystem.

## Institutional precedent

- Government of Alberta, *Supporting Safe and Inclusive Lives: Report of the Persons with Developmental Disabilities Safety Standards Consultation 2016, Plain Language Version*, John te Linde (Chair).  
Referenced in Section 15 as documentary precedent for community consultation processes in Alberta.

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